

MARIUS MERCIER

PHD STUDENT · ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE (ENS-PSL), INSTITUT JEAN NICOD
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EDUCATION

École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Institut Jean Nicod <i>PhD Psychology</i> - Supervisor: Hugo Mercier - Thesis: How do we infer others' competence?	2024 – <i>Paris, FR</i>
École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL) <i>MA Cognitive Science — ENS Diploma</i> Final Year Ranking: 1/78	2021 – 2024 <i>Paris, FR</i>
University of Princeton <i>Visiting Student Research Collaborator</i> Supervisor: Alin Coman	Feb. 2023 – Jun. 2023 <i>Princeton, NJ, USA</i>
University of Cambridge <i>Visiting Research Student</i> Supervisor: Lee de-Wit	Sep. 2022 – Jan. 2023 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Sciences Po Bordeaux <i>BA Political Studies</i>	2018 – 2021 <i>Bordeaux, FR</i>
University Paul Valéry <i>BA Philosophy</i>	2018 – 2021 <i>Montpellier, FR</i>

PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed Publications

- Dubourg, E., Thouzeau, V., ..., **Mercier, M.**, ..., Baumard, N. (2026) Carving stories at their natural joints *Psychological Review*. Advance online publication.
- Mercier, M.**[†], de Lanerolle, R.[†], Morin, O., Quillien, T. & Mercier, H. (2026) Inferring Arithmetic Skill from Speed and Accuracy. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 48. [†]*Equal contribution*.
- Mercier, M.**, Morin, O., Mercier, H., Quillien, T. (2026) Who knows what? Bayesian competence inference guides knowledge attribution and information search *Cognition*, 273, 106533.
- Mercier, M.**, Garsmeur, A. & Mercier, H. (2025) The Appeal of Insight: Why Riddles and Whodunits Captivate Us *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts*. Advance online publication.
- Mercier, M.**, Dubourg, E. & Mercier, H. (2025) Insight-seeking is consistent across domains and distinct from other forms of curiosity *Personality and Individual Differences*, 237, 113051.

Working Papers

- Mercier, M.**, Baudouin, N. & Mercier, H. (2026) People have an accurate folk theory of conspiracy believers (*Under review*)

PRESENTATIONS

Conferences

- Bayesian Inference of Competence guides Knowledge Attribution and Information Search** [Poster] 2026
Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, BR
- Inferring Arithmetic Skill from Speed and Accuracy** [Poster] 2026
Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, BR
- Inferring Minds from Limited Information** [Talk] 2026
Human Behaviour & Evolution Society, Rabat, MA

3. **Bayesian Inference in Competence Evaluation** [Poster] 2025
Symposium on the Biology of Decision Making, Lyon, FR
2. **In Search of Experts: Bayesian Inference of Knowledgeability from Minimal Cues** [Talk] 2025
European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, Newcastle, UK
1. **The Appeal of Insight: Why Riddles and Whodunits Captivate Us** [Talk] 2025
Explaining Culture Conference, Paris, FR

Invited Talks

3. **Bayesian models of competence inference** 2026
Edinburgh Cognitive Sciences Conference, University of Edinburgh
2. **The Appeal of Insight: Cultural Preferences, Personality and Metacognition** 2025
CreaTeam, Frontlab, Paris Brain Institute
1. **How do People Judge Competence from Minimal Cues?** 2025
Laboratoire de Neurosciences Cognitives et Computationnelles LNC² - Social Cognition Team, ENS-PSL

TEACHING

Courses

- Introduction to Experimental Psychology** | *PSL University* 2025 – 2026
 • Sole Instructor, Undergraduate Course, 30h
- Human Behaviour Culture and Societies** | *École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL)* 2024 – 2025
 • Teaching Assistant, Graduate Course
 • Taught with Nicolas Baumard & Jean-Baptiste André

Guest Lectures

- The Appeal of Insight** | *CPES Données Arts et Cultures – PSL, LLG* 2025

Student internship supervision

6. Solène Basle, *undergraduate* 2025 – 2026
5. Luna Gourrier, *undergraduate* 2025 – 2026
4. Nell Souami, *undergraduate* 2025 – 2026
3. Ruby De Lanerolle, *undergraduate* 2025
2. Nina Vivier Barte, *undergraduate* 2024 – 2025
1. Clementine Allais, *undergraduate* 2024 – 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Data Scientist** 2023 – Present
Noèse

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Ad hoc reviewer:** *Cognition (1); Proceedings of the Cognitive Science Society (1)*

SCIENCE OUTREACH

General Audience Talks

1. Interactive experience and game on psychological consequences of inequalities. **Nuit Européenne des Chercheurs**, Brest 2023